

Chapter 176-3

Zhu Mingqi was very surprised. After understanding these three paintings, she offered 1.5 million to buy them. But Chen Mian shook her head, saying she would paint another one for Zhu Mingqi for free, but these three paintings were intended for someone else.

Zhu Mingqi didn't insist.

Because they had chatted so enjoyably, and it happened to be near lunchtime, Zhu Mingqi said she wanted to treat them to a meal.

Chen Mian glanced at Liang Shi. Neither of them refused.

When Liang Shi was about to leave, Chen Mian packed up the three paintings and handed them to Liang Shi, asking her to give them to Liang Wanwan at an appropriate time.

Liang Shi: "....."

As expected.

Later, when Liang Shi happened to go abroad for filming, she brought these three paintings to Liang Wanwan.

On the day she received these three paintings, Liang Wanwan cried uncontrollably in that foreign land.

Drunk, Liang Wanwan shouted at the rooftop: "Chen Mian, I give up."

"I will never like you again."

"You must be happy, Chen Mian."

Of course, that was all later.

At this moment, Liang Shi put the paintings in her car, then got into Zhu Mingqi's car together with Chen Mian.

In the car, Liang Shi was relatively quiet because Zhu Mingqi and Chen Mian were discussing art—a topic she couldn't contribute to.

However, Zhu Mingqi later changed the subject. "A-Shi, you're quite familiar with Xiao Xue, right?"

After saying this, she paused briefly: "You don't mind if I call you A-Shi, do you?"

"I don't mind." Liang Shi put away her phone and smiled awkwardly. "You still remember what happened that day."

If one really thought about it, accompanying Gu Yixue into that wedding hall and watching that absurd scene was one of the brave things Liang Shi had done in her lifetime.

Zhu Mingqi nodded: "Of course. I was quite startled at the time."

Liang Shi smiled lightly: "Sorry about that."

"It's fine, it wasn't your fault." Zhu Mingqi started chatting casually with her. "I really don't understand these kids nowadays. My eldest daughter's wedding was delayed for so long, and when they finally held it, that incident happened. Her father got so angry that night he fell ill."

Liang Shi: "...Ah, I see."

"It has nothing to do with you," Zhu Mingqi said. "But comparatively speaking, I do like Xiao Xue more. It seems my eldest also prefers Xiao Xue. That girl Gu Chunmian—her heart isn't in the right place."

Liang Shi listened silently, not daring to voice any opinions.

She wasn't really familiar with Gu Chunmian to begin with, and she knew very little about the relationship between Gu Yixue and Shen Fenghe. When she bravely crashed the wedding venue with Gu Yixue, she was just doing it from a friend's standpoint.

Besides, it couldn't really be called snatching the bride.

At most, it could be called picking up what others discarded.¹

"I've said too much again." Zhu Mingqi belatedly realized she had shared all her thoughts and smiled helplessly. "I'm an old woman. I don't socialize much normally, so whenever I chat with young people, I tend to talk a lot."

"It's fine." Liang Shi smiled lightly. "Please go ahead. I'm listening."

Zhu Mingqi looked at her again and once more expressed regret: "If only you weren't married, Little Liang."

Liang Shi: "?"

"I've always wanted to introduce you to my second daughter." Zhu Mingqi said.

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi cleared her throat, accidentally choking on her own saliva, and started coughing frantically.

This startled Zhu Mingqi.

"Are you okay?" Zhu Mingqi immediately apologized. "Sorry, I didn't mean to. I'm not saying you should get divorced or anything. I was just expressing how much I like you. Please don't misunderstand."

Liang Shi: "....."

It took quite a while before Liang Shi calmed down, though her face was flushed red from coughing.

Zhu Mingqi said helplessly: "I just like you too much. I felt a connection with you from the moment I saw you. How can a young girl be so beautiful?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She looked at Zhu Mingqi.

The appreciation in Zhu Mingqi's eyes couldn't be faked. She really did like her a lot.

Liang Shi smiled politely: "Thank you for your kind regard."

"Just don't feel offended." Zhu Mingqi said. "Since you're married, I certainly wish you and your spouse a hundred years of harmony."

Liang Shi nodded: "Thank you."

She didn't know what else to say.

"As for my second daughter." Zhu Mingqi shook her head. "Her temper is too stubborn, just like her father. A complete love-brain,² nothing like me at all. If she can't be with you, that's her lack of fortune."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Shen Hui was a love-brain?

Well, there was a little bit of that.

But...

"You don't know yet?" Liang Shi asked tentatively.

"Know what?" Zhu Mingqi asked.

Liang Shi immediately waved her hand: "No... nothing."

It seemed she still didn't know about Shen Hui and Zhao Xuning.

"What is it exactly?" Her attitude aroused Zhu Mingqi's curiosity. "Being all hesitant like that—is it about A-Hui?"

Liang Shi still didn't say: "You'll know when the time comes."

Silently praying for Zhao Xuning online.

Zhu Mingqi laughed: "So mysterious."

Amid the conversation and laughter, they arrived at the restaurant.

The place Zhu Mingqi brought them to was a high-end restaurant. One needed to spend at least a million at this establishment to even have a name there, but the service and dishes were genuinely excellent.

It was clear that Zhu Mingqi truly liked them and wasn't stingy at all.

1. "撿漏" (jiǎn lòu) literally means "picking up a leak" or finding a bargain that others missed. In this context, Liang Shi is humorously saying that rather than "stealing" the bride, they were just picking up someone who had been abandoned/discarded at the altar. ⇐
2. "戀愛腦" (liàn'ài nǎo) literally "love brain" - a popular Chinese internet slang term describing someone who becomes completely consumed by romantic love, often to the point of losing rationality and making love their top priority above all else. ⇐